



REACH for a Friend Guide

Listen, encourage, connect, and follow up without carrying everything alone.

MADE FOR

Friends, roommates, classmates, mentors, and student leaders

Use this toolkit as a planning guide. Requirements, deadlines, and availability are set by each school, scholarship, agency, or provider. EFF cannot guarantee funding or outside assistance.

portal.estherfundsfoundation.org | estherfundsfoundation.org

Use L.E.C.F.

LISTEN	I noticed you seem overwhelmed. How are you really doing?
ENCOURAGE	I am glad you told me. You deserve support.
CONNECT	Would it help if I sat with you while we contact someone?
FOLLOW UP	How did the financial aid or counseling conversation go?

Match support to the need

Situation	Connection
Food, housing, utilities	211, campus basic-needs office, FindHelp.org
Tuition / financial aid	Financial aid, student accounts, dean of students
Mental-health crisis	Call or text 988
Immediate danger	Call 911
Sexual violence	RAINN: 800-656-HOPE / rainn.org
Domestic violence	thehotline.org / 800-799-SAFE

Boundaries are care

- Do not promise secrecy if someone may be unsafe
- Do not act as a counselor, lender, or sole support person
- Share only relevant resources instead of overwhelming them
- Tell a trusted professional when the situation exceeds your role
- Take care of your own wellbeing after a heavy conversation

CHECK IN	One specific follow-up is more helpful than saying, Let me know if you need anything.
-----------------	---